

Lirias Arcade

Install Guide

Written for complete beginners -- no coding experience required.

A gift from Liria.

Welcome

This guide walks you through setting up Lirias Arcade from a completely empty computer -- no software installed, no prior experience with Python, Node.js, or RetroArch assumed. Follow the sections in order and you will have a working arcade cabinet front-end by the end.

Sections in this guide:

- 1. Installing prerequisites (Node.js)
- 2. Installing RetroArch and emulator cores
- 3. A note on game files (ROMs) and BIOS files
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1. Installing Prerequisites

Do I need Python?

No. Lirias Arcade's server is built entirely with Node.js. You do not need to install Python or any Python packages to run this project. The only runtime you need is Node.js, covered below.

Step 1 -- Install Node.js

Node.js is the free program that runs the Lirias Arcade web server on your computer.

1. Open your web browser and go to nodejs.org.
2. Click the button offering the "LTS" (Long Term Support) version -- this is the stable, recommended version. Do not pick the "Current" version.
3. The site will download an installer file (it will look like `node-v20.x.x-x64.msi` or similar). Once it finishes downloading, double-click it to open the installer.
4. Click "Next" through the installer screens, accept the license agreement, and leave all options at their default settings. Click "Install", then "Finish" when it's done.
5. Restart your computer. This ensures Node.js is fully recognized by Windows.

Step 2 -- Verify Node.js installed correctly

1. Press the Windows key, type "cmd", and press Enter to open the Command Prompt (a black text window).
2. Type the following and press Enter:

```
node --version
```

If installation succeeded, you'll see a version number such as `v20.11.0`. If you instead see an error like "node is not recognized", restart your computer and try again -- if it still fails, re-run the Node.js installer from Step 1.

3. You can close the Command Prompt window now.

Step 3 -- First-time setup of Lirias Arcade

The project already includes a one-click launcher that installs its own small set of Node.js dependencies automatically the first time you run it -- you do not need to type any install commands yourself.

1. Open the Lirias-Arcade folder.
2. Double-click `Launch-Arcade.bat`.

The first time you run it, a window will briefly appear installing dependencies (this is normal and only happens once). After that, your web browser will automatically open the game select screen at `http://localhost:8080`.

2. Installing RetroArch and Emulator Cores

RetroArch is the free, open-source program that actually plays your game ROMs (SNES, Genesis, N64, PlayStation, and arcade games). Lirias Arcade is just the pretty menu screen in front of it -- RetroArch does the emulation.

Step 1 -- Download and install RetroArch

1. Go to retroarch.com in your web browser.
2. Click "Download", then choose Windows (and the correct 64-bit / "x86_64" option for most modern PCs).
3. Run the downloaded installer and click through it using the default options.
4. Once installed, note the folder you installed it to (by default this is something like C:\RetroArch-Win64). You'll need this path in Step 3 below.

Step 2 -- Install the required cores

A "core" is a plugin that teaches RetroArch how to emulate one specific game system. Lirias Arcade needs six cores, one per system:

- FinalBurn Neo (fbneo) -- for the fbneo folder (arcade games)
- MAME2003-Plus (mame2003_plus) -- for the mame folder
- SNES9x (snes9x) -- for the snes folder
- Genesis Plus GX (genesis_plus_gx) -- for the genesis folder
- Mupen64Plus-Next (mupen64plus_next) -- for the n64 folder
- PCSX ReARMed (pcsx_rearmed) -- for the psx folder

1. Open RetroArch.
2. From the main menu, go to "Online Updater" (on older versions this may be under "Main Menu" or "Content Downloader").
3. Select "Core Downloader" (sometimes called "Core Updater").
4. One at a time, find and select each of the six cores listed above and let it download and install. RetroArch will confirm each one once it's finished.

Once downloaded, the core files (with names like fbneo_libretro.dll) live inside RetroArch's own "cores" folder, typically something like C:\RetroArch-Win64\cores.

Step 3 -- Point Lirias Arcade at your RetroArch install

Open the file `frontend\config.json` inside the Lirias-Arcade folder using Notepad (right-click the file, choose "Open with", then Notepad). Update these two lines to match where you installed RetroArch:

```
"retroarchPath": "E:/RetroArch/retroarch.exe",  
"coresDir": "E:/RetroArch/cores"
```

Replace the example paths with your own install location, save the file (Ctrl+S), and close Notepad. Use forward slashes (/) even though this is Windows -- the example above shows the correct format.

Step 4 -- Copy the included RetroArch settings (optional but recommended)

A starter `retroarch.cfg` file sits in the main Lirias-Arcade folder. It sets up sensible defaults (keyboard controls, gamepad auto-detection for up to 4 controllers, fullscreen). Lirias Arcade applies it automatically each time it launches a game, so you don't need to do anything further -- but if you want these same settings for RetroArch generally, you can copy/merge it into RetroArch's own configuration folder.

3. About Game Files (ROMs) and BIOS Files

No ROMs or BIOS files are included

This repository does not include, provide, distribute, or link to any game ROMs, disc images, or console BIOS files -- for any system, including the PlayStation BIOS files described below.

You are responsible for sourcing any game or BIOS files yourself, from ethical and legal sources only -- for example, by personally dumping/backing up physical games and consoles that you own.

This project does not endorse, recommend, or provide instructions for obtaining copyrighted game or BIOS files from any other source. Downloading copyrighted ROMs or BIOS files you do not own the rights to may be illegal in your country.

It is your responsibility to understand and follow the copyright and emulation laws that apply where you live before adding any files to this project.

PlayStation BIOS files

The PCSX ReARMed core needs a real PlayStation BIOS to run PSX games -- RetroArch cannot emulate a PlayStation without one. The bios folder in this project is included as an empty placeholder (no BIOS files ship inside it). If you own a PlayStation console, you may dump your own BIOS chip and place the resulting files, named exactly as below, into the bios folder:

- scph1001.bin
- scph5501.bin
- scph7001.bin

This guide does not provide instructions on how or where to obtain these files -- only their expected names and location, for use with a BIOS you have legally sourced yourself. The bios\Mupen64plus folder that ships with this project contains only a public N64 game catalog and shader-cache files used by the N64 core -- it contains no console firmware and requires nothing further from you.

4. Folder Structure -- Where Your Files Go

Once you have your own legally-obtained game files ready, place each one into the folder matching its system, inside Lirias-Arcade\roms\:

```
Lirias-Arcade/  
  roms/  
    fbneo/      <- FinalBurn Neo (arcade games)  
    genesis/    <- Sega Genesis / Mega Drive  
    mame/       <- Multiple Arcade Machine Emulator  
    n64/        <- Nintendo 64  
    psx/        <- PlayStation  
    snes/       <- Super Nintendo
```

The select screen scans these folders automatically every time it loads -- simply drop a game file into the matching folder and refresh your browser (or relaunch the arcade); there's no rebuild or install step required.

Quick reference

- fbneo = FinalBurn Neo, for arcade board games (CPS1/CPS2/Neo Geo)
- genesis = Sega Genesis / Mega Drive games
- mame = Multiple Arcade Machine Emulator, for classic arcade games
- n64 = Nintendo 64 games
- psx = PlayStation games
- snes = Super Nintendo games

5. Modifying This Software

You are welcome to modify, customize, and extend Lirias Arcade to fit your own cabinet, collection, or preferences -- the code is yours to change.

Provided "as-is"

This software is provided "as-is," without warranty of any kind, express or implied. Whether you use it unmodified or make changes of your own, no guarantee is made that it will work correctly, be free of bugs, or be fit for any particular purpose.

No responsibility is claimed or accepted for any issues, damages, data loss, hardware problems, or other consequences that may arise from using or modifying this project. You take on that risk yourself, and any changes you make are your own responsibility.

6. Setting Up Background Music

The game select screen is designed to play a track named `alice.mp3` from the `Lirias-Arcade\music` folder while you browse games. This audio file is not included in this project, due to copyright -- the music folder ships empty.

Option A -- Supply your own `alice.mp3` (recommended, no code changes)

If you have your own audio file that you own the rights to, or that is licensed for this kind of use (royalty-free music, Creative Commons tracks, or something you composed/recorded yourself), you can enable music with no editing required:

1. Rename your audio file to exactly: `alice.mp3`
2. Copy it into the `Lirias-Arcade\music` folder.
3. Relaunch the arcade (or refresh the browser tab) and music will begin playing automatically once you interact with the page.

To rename a file on Windows: right-click the file, choose "Rename", type the new name including ".mp3" at the end, and press Enter. If Windows is hiding file extensions, make sure you don't end up with a double extension like `alice.mp3.mp3` -- the Details view in File Explorer will confirm the file's real name and type.

Option B -- Keep your file's original name (edit the code instead)

If you'd rather not rename your audio file, you can instead tell the code to look for your file's actual name. Open `frontend\index.html` in Notepad and find this line near the top of the file:

```
<audio id="bgm" src="/music/alice.mp3" loop preload="auto"></audio>
```

Change `alice.mp3` to your file's exact name (for example, `my-song.mp3`), save the file, and place that audio file in the `Lirias-Arcade\music` folder. Relaunch the arcade to hear the change.

7. Changing the Banner Image

The background image behind the game select screen is currently frontend\assets\Liria-Arcade-Banner.jpg.

Option A -- Replace the file directly (no code changes)

1. Choose the image you'd like to use instead.
2. Rename it to exactly: Liria-Arcade-Banner.jpg
3. Copy it into frontend\assets, overwriting the existing file when Windows asks.

A wide image (landscape orientation, similar proportions to a widescreen monitor) will look best, since it's used as a full-screen background.

Option B -- Keep your image's original name (edit the code instead)

Open frontend\style.css in Notepad and use Find (Ctrl+F) to search for: Liria-Arcade-Banner.jpg

You'll find it referenced in two places, each inside a background-image style rule, similar to:

```
background-image: url('assets/Liria-Arcade-Banner.jpg');
```

Replace both occurrences with your own file's name (for example, assets/my-banner.jpg), save the file, and place your image in frontend\assets. Refresh the browser tab to see the new banner.

8. License, Warranty, and Legal Disclaimer

Lirias Arcade is open-source tooling: a menu/launcher front-end for RetroArch, provided free of charge, with no game content of any kind included.

No warranty

This software is provided "as-is," without warranty of any kind, either expressed or implied, including but not limited to the implied warranties of merchantability and fitness for a particular purpose. In no event shall the authors or contributors be held liable for any claim, damages, or other liability arising from, out of, or in connection with the software, or its use or other dealings in the software.

Your responsibility

You are solely responsible for ensuring that anything you add to this project -- game ROMs, BIOS files, replacement music, replacement images, or code changes -- complies with the copyright and other laws that apply to you. This project does not provide, host, endorse, or link to copyrighted game content, BIOS files, or unlicensed media of any kind, and takes no responsibility for how you choose to use it.

9. A Note From Liria

Lirias Arcade is offered freely, as a gift from Liria.

If you've enjoyed it and would like to support the Hotel Liria project, donations are always appreciated at:

DeFiFry.eth

Thank you for playing, and enjoy the arcade.